Practice Task: Build a Landing Page

Level: Beginner **Tools:** a text editor (e.g. VS Code) and a web browser

Goal

Build a one-page website for a small business. Pick something you find fun: a bakery, a bike repair shop, a dog walker, a barber, a game store. The page should introduce the business, list what it offers, and tell visitors how to get in touch. There is no single correct result. Take your time, experiment, and break things; that is how you learn.

You will use **HTML** to describe what is on the page and **CSS** to control how it looks. Keep these two jobs separate in your head: HTML is the content and structure, CSS is the presentation.

Setup

1. Create a folder for the project and give it a sensible name.
2. Inside it, create two files: **index.html** and **style.css**.
3. Open **index.html** in your browser. Every time you save a change, refresh the browser to see the result.

Part 1: HTML, the structure

Every HTML page needs the same basic skeleton. Type this out yourself rather than copying it, so you start remembering it:

```
<!DOCTYPE html>
<html lang="en">
<head>
  <meta charset="UTF-8">
  <title>Your Business Name</title>
  <link rel="stylesheet" href="style.css">
</head>
<body>

</body>
</html>
```

The **head** holds information about the page (its title, its stylesheet) that is not shown on the page itself. Everything visitors actually see goes inside the **body**. The **link** line is what connects your CSS file to the page, so your styles will not work without it.

Now build the content inside the body. Think about how a real business website is laid out from top to bottom:

1. **The top of the page.** Use a **header** element. It should contain the business name as the main heading and a navigation area (the **nav** element) with links to the sections further down the page. Think about which sections a visitor would want to jump to.
2. **The main content.** Wrap the middle of the page in a **main** element and split it into separate **section** elements. At minimum you need one that tells visitors about the business, one that lists what it offers, and one with contact details. Each section should start with its own heading, and the headings should be the right level (there is only one top-level heading on a page).
3. **The bottom of the page.** Finish with a **footer** element for small print such as a copyright line.

Fill the sections with real content, not placeholder words. Write a few sentences about the business, add at least one image (and think about what the alt text should say for someone who cannot see it), present the offerings as a list, and make the contact details useful: an email address that opens a mail app when clicked, for example.

Making the nav links work. Links can point to places on the same page, not just other websites. Look up how the **id** attribute and a link starting with # work together, then connect each nav link to its section.

Checkpoint: the page will look plain and unstyled, but all the content should be present, the structure should make sense when you read it top to bottom, and the nav links should take you to the right sections.

Part 2: CSS, the styling

Now make it look good. Work in **style.css**, change one thing at a time, and refresh the browser after each change so you can see exactly what each rule does. If something does not work, check for typos and missing semicolons first.

1. **Set the foundations.** Browsers add default spacing around the page that you usually want to remove. Choose a readable font and a comfortable line spacing for the whole page. Pick a text colour that is easy on the eyes (pure black on pure white is harsher than it needs to be).
2. **Style the header.** Give it a background colour and make sure the text stays readable against it. Turn the nav links into a horizontal row with some space between them, and remove the default link underline and colour so they match your design.
3. **Control the width.** Text that stretches across a wide screen is hard to read. Limit how wide the main content can get and centre it on the page. Add padding so the content does not touch the edges.
4. **Give sections room.** Add spacing between the sections and find a subtle way to separate them visually, such as a thin line or alternating background colours.
5. **Tame the image.** Large images can overflow their container. Make sure yours scales down to fit, and try softening it with rounded corners.
6. **Make links feel alive.** Style links so that something changes when the mouse is over them. Look up pseudo-classes to find out how.
7. **Finish the footer.** Give it its own look so it feels like the end of the page.

Tip: right-click anything on your page in the browser and choose Inspect. The developer tools show which CSS rules apply to an element and let you try changes live before you edit your file.

Bonus ideas

Optional, for when you want to push further. You will need to research these yourself.

- Lay out the list of offerings as a row of cards instead of a vertical list (look up flexbox).
- Keep the header visible at the top while scrolling.
- Make clicking a nav link scroll smoothly instead of jumping.
- Make the page work well on a phone-sized screen (look up media queries).
- Change the colours and fonts until the page matches the personality of your business.

Self-check

- [ ] The page has the full skeleton (doctype, html, head, body)
- [ ] Header, nav, main, three sections, and footer are all present
- [ ] Headings are used in a sensible order
- [ ] Nav links jump to the correct sections
- [ ] The image has meaningful alt text
- [ ] The CSS lives in its own file and is linked correctly
- [ ] The page is centred, readable, and consistently styled